

David Yan

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

I currently work on understanding *what makes good training data* for downstream tasks by leveraging controllable synthetic data. I have broad interests in vision, robotics, representation learning, and generative models.

EDUCATION

Princeton University <i>Incoming PhD Student - Computer Science (Advisor: Jia Deng)</i>	09/26 - 05/31
Princeton University <i>B.S.E. in Computer Science, summa cum laude; Minors in Mathematics and Philosophy</i>	08/22 - 05/26

PUBLICATIONS

- Scaling the Horizon of Contrastive Reinforcement Learning
David Yan, Brandon Cho, Andrew Tu, Vedant Badoni, Zechang Yang, Raj Ghugare, Benjamin Eysenbach
RLC 2026 Workshop on Reinforcement Learning Beyond Rewards.
- ProcFunc: Function-Oriented Abstractions for Procedural 3D Generation in Python.
Alexander Raistrick, Karhan Kayan, Jack Nugent, **David Yan**, Lingjie Mei, Meenal Parakh, Hongyu Wen, Dylan Li, Yiming Zuo, Erich Liang, Jia Deng.
arXiv.
- What Makes Good Synthetic Training Data for Zero-Shot Stereo Matching?
David Yan, Alexander Raistrick, Jia Deng.
CVPR 2026, Spotlight.
- Infinigen Indoors: Photorealistic Indoor Scenes using Procedural Generation.
Alexander Raistrick*, Lingjie Mei*, Karhan Kaan Kayan*, **David Yan**, Yiming Zuo, Beining Han, Hongyu Wen, Meenal Parakh, Stamatis Alexandropoulos, Lahav Lipson, Zeyu Ma, Jia Deng.
CVPR 2024.

HONORS AND AWARDS

Francis Robbins Upton Graduate Fellowship	2026
Outstanding Senior Thesis Prize	2026
Phi Beta Kappa	2026
Sigma Xi	2026
Honorable Mention, CRA Outstanding Undergraduate Researcher Award	2025
Shapiro Prize for Academic Excellence (x2)	2023, 2024
Tau Beta Pi	2024
U.S. Presidential Scholar	2022
Research Science Institute (RSI) Scholar	2021

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Intern , Elorian	6/26 - 9/26
Graduate Student Researcher , Princeton Vision and Learning Lab - <i>Advised by Jia Deng</i>	2026 - 2031
Visiting Student , Stanford Vision and Learning Lab - <i>Advised by Jiajun Wu</i>	5/25 - 8/25
Undergraduate Researcher , Princeton Vision and Learning Lab - <i>Advised by Jia Deng</i>	2023 - Present

Reviewing

- International Conference on 3D Vision (3DV 2026)

Computer Vision Course Assistant

- Co-led overhaul of COS429, Princeton's undergraduate computer vision course.
- Made significant changes to the course syllabus, modernizing over a third of the course content with new material.

Princeton ACM Officer

- Organized a weekly computer vision reading group. I lead discussion on selected papers in computer vision research. We aim to increase engagement into undergraduate computer science research, particularly in computer vision, deep learning, and related subfields.

Teaching Assistant

- COS240 (Discrete Math) - Spring 2024